Silver Peaks Rogaine

Saturday 23rd September 2006

Your team number is

FINAL INSTRUCTIONS TO COMPETITORS.

Please ensure all your team members read this document. It contains important information.

Thank you for your entry in the Silver Peaks Rogaine. This information is sent to the team leader only so please copy it to all other members of your team. A copy is also available on the New Zealand Rogaining Association website, http://www.rogaine.org.nz . Attached are Indemnity and Emergency contact forms to be completed by all members of your team and to be handed in at registration. See the website for a list of competitors and up-to-date information.

Acknowledgements

We are indebted to all the landowners who have so willingly allowed us to use their land. Without their cooperation we would not have an event.

City Forests Limited
Wenita Forest Products Limited
Department of Conservation
Mr M Cowie, Silver Peaks Station

Organisers' Contact Details

The organizers may be contacted by telephone or email.

Bob Cunninghame Ph (03) 473 8330 Dunedin Email: **signalhill@xtra.co.nz**

For **emergency only**, during the event, contact the event centre on 027 351 0146 or 021 295 4880.

Directions to the Site

The event headquarters is at the former stock yards in Big Creek beside the Mt Allan Road, but note that **Registration and Map Issue for the 12-hour event is at the Taieri Harrier Club Rooms in Mosgiel. (See below)**. Rogaine direction signs will be in place at some intersections from early Saturday morning.

Registration & Event Headquarters

Registration for the 12 hour event and route planning is at the Taieri Harrier Club Rooms, Memorial Park, Mosgiel from 5.45 am to 7.15 am. Memorial Park lies between Gordon Road and Reid Avenue and is the second block northwest along Gordon Road from the traffic lights in the centre of Mosgiel. Cars can enter from Gordon Road (turn right, Rogaine sign) and park near the grandstand and sports complex. Walk round the back of the buildings to the far end and the harrier club rooms are in a separate building. Parking outside these is limited and is reserved for the organizers.

The rooms will be closed at 7.15 am and any remaining (late) registrations will be done at the event headquarters - a 35 minute drive away and late registrations may not be possible until after the official start time of 8.15 am. The finish time will not be extended for late teams. There is a compulsory briefing for all competitors at 8.00 am.

Registration for the 6 hour event is at the event headquarters (start and finish area) from 12.15 pm. There is a compulsory briefing at 1.15 pm and the start time is 1.30 pm. The finish time will not be extended for late teams.

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To reach the **Event headquarters** from Mosgiel travel northwest along Gordon Road (care at the five-roads intersection about 1 km from the outskirts of Mosgiel, where there is a kink in Gordon Road). Continue across the plain through two more intersections, after which the road (now Taioma Road) climbs onto higher land. There will be a Rogaine sign at the beginning of Taioma Rd. After reaching the crest of the ridge, the road is unsealed and becomes progressively narrower. Continue along Taioma (Mt Allan)

Road and ignore the side road (east) to Salisbury (Rogaine sign). **The road descends steeply to cross the railway line at Taioma (no buildings left!). This is a working line (Taieri Gorge Railway) and expect to meet trains here – particularly those coming in for the six-hour event and anyone who may leave early.** There is a steep climb on a loose surface out of the valley and the road winds over and along undulating ridges before descending steeply into Big Stream valley. The Event Headquarters is less than a kilometre on along the road at a large open area marked as "yards" on the map. The drive from the centre of Mosgiel takes approximately 35 minutes.

Please take care on the road. It is a public road and some of the other users do drive at high speed and in the middle of the road. One of the planning team had to take evasive action to avoid a collision and needed to be towed back onto the road. The offending car did not stop!

Facilities at event headquarters. There is no accommodation at the rogaine area, and minimal facilities (toilets are provided). Each team should bring sufficient water for their own requirements and it would be appreciated if extra containers of water were brought to help the organisers. Six-hour participants should bring their own tables and chairs and be prepared to plan inside vehicles if it is raining. There is no cellphone reception at event headquarters. No smoking and no fires are to be lit.

Important Note: If you are a competitor **and** the driver of a car please have sufficient rest before heading home.

Registration and Start Procedure

Your team (one member is adequate) should present a completed Indemnity and Emergency Contact Form at the registration desk. Make sure you have entered your team number on the form. If no money is owing, the team will be issued with checkpoint descriptions, maps, and any last-minute course notes. (Any money owing must be paid before maps will be issued. Correct change would be appreciated). Any changes in team composition must be advised.

Each team must also ensure they pick up a "flight plan" map. Plan your route and complete the "flight plan" map, which must be placed in the box provided at the administration desk. The flight plan is not binding, but gives the organizers an indication of the route, should a search have to be mounted for a team that does not return!

You must attend the compulsory briefing for all competitors that will be held at 8.00 am (1.15 pm for 6 hour option).

If you have never been in a Rogaine before, novice instruction will be available. Please ask at registration.

Event Timetable

Saturday 23rd September

5.45am Registration opens at Taieri Harrier Club Rooms (**Indemnity form essential**) and maps issued for 12 hr teams. Novice instruction available if required.

7.15 am Registration and map issue close and all move to the event headquarters and start/finish area in Mt Allan Forest. Note that the rooms will be closed and no rogaine organizers will be present after this time.

8.00 am Compulsory Briefing for all 12 hr teams at event headquarters.

8.15 am Massed start for 12 hr event.
Note that any late starters have the same finish time as those at the massed start.

12 noon Registration opens at event headquarters for 6 hr event. Novice instruction available if required.
1.15 pm Compulsory briefing
1.30 pm 6hr mass start
Note that any late starters have the same finish time as those at the massed start

7.30 pm Finish of 6 hr event – late penalties after this time (see below).

8.15 pm Finish of 12 hr event – late penalties after this time (see below).

7.30 pm Taieri Harrier Club rooms open for competitors with some light refreshments available. For those who require a meal, there are several "take aways" in Mosgiel and we suggest that you bring your meal along with you. Results will be announced as soon as possible after course closure and there will be prizes for top place-getters as well as spot prizes for those present. Late finishers will cause significant delays to the prize giving as the organizers cannot leave event headquarters until everyone has been accounted for.

Map and Course

The map is A3 in size, is pre-marked with the checkpoint positions, and has out-of-bounds areas overprinted. It is vertically oriented to true north, and is based on the standard 1:50,000 topographical series, with 20 m contours. Grid lines 1 km apart show true North and East. There will be one map per competitor. You will need to bring a plastic bag or contact covering as the map is not waterproof. There is NO LEGEND on the map, but one will be posted on the event noticeboard.

The terrain is steep ridge, spur, gully and valley country. About three quarters of the map is conifer forest - a mix of radiata pine and Douglas fir plantation, with the remainder native scrub, beech forest and open tussock country. The altitude ranges (approx) from 200m to 780m over the course. The northern part of the forest is mature and fairly open underneath. The southern half is younger and travel through it is not recommended although clear lines may be found at times. There are numerous forest roads and tracks throughout the forests. Maps showing the mature and immature forests will be on display to assist with route planning.

Ponds If a checkpoint is described as a/the pond it will be obvious even if dry.

Cliffs Cliffs are not marked, but there are some in the northeast part of the map and there are also small cliffs in parts of the forest. Be careful – particularly in failing light in the forest.

All stream crossings should be approached with care. In the streams themselves there are deep pools, but shallow fords are found readily.

There will be only two water drops on the course apart from event headquarters. It will not be possible to replenish these during the day, please do not waste water. Each person should carry a minimum of two litres from the start. Some of the streams on higher ground are probably safe to drink. There will be water and hot drinks available at the event headquarters throughout the day.

Safety

Some roads are open to the public and you must obey normal road rules and etiquet. Beware of four-wheel-drive vehicles and trail bikes on the Mt Allan Road. Vehicles (trail bikes and mountain bikes may be met on "closed" forest roads). **Bright (reflective) clothing is recommended** for those on roads late in the day.

Pig hunters frequent this area and while permit holders have been asked to keep away during the event, there may be unauthorised hunters in the area. If you hear packs of dogs or shots be cautious. **Again bright clothing is recommended**.

Route Intention map

You will find a black-and-white map of the Rogaine, reduced to A4 size, in your registration pack. After you plan your course, mark it out on this map including the direction you will go and your estimated nightfall place. It is a "flight plan" to give the event organisers an indication of where you might be found if a search becomes necessary. You do not have to stick to the route you have specified; it is an indication only. Place the completed map in a box that will be provided at the registration desk. Don't forget to put your team number on it. It will be dark from between 7 -7.30 pm depending on cloud cover and where you are.

Fences, Tracks, and Out-of-Bounds areas

As usual, tracks and fences exist which are not marked on the map, and others are marked but no longer exist. In many cases they serve as useful navigational aids, but you should not assume their accuracy without other supporting information, such as contours.

Assume that all electric fences are on. Use a plastic map bag to hold the wires if necessary.

Out of Bounds areas.

Some areas have been marked and these are not to be entered – any team so doing will be disqualified

Weather and Equipment

The north-eastern part of the map is an exposed area so be prepared for sudden changes of temperature, wind and visibility. Strong, warm NW winds or cold SW winds with driving squalls of rain, hail and snow may be expected at this time of year. Cloud can cover the higher ground very rapidly particularly in the late afternoon on a fine day with a light northeast wind. In settled conditions the climate at this time of year is ideal for rogaines. A weather forecast will be available at the registration area.

A suggested <u>minimum</u> equipment and clothing list is:

Polypropylene or woollen top and trousers.
A heavy waterproof parka.
Gaiters or leggings.
Food.
Water bottle (2 litres minimum).
A whistle each.
A basic first-aid kit for the team,
A large (A3) plastic bag or some clear plastic stick-on covering to protect your map.
A warm hat and mitts.
An extra jersey or fleece top.
Torches, and batteries for 3 hours.
A compass and pencil.
Suitable shoes or boots with a good grip.
A daypack

For the six-hour event this list may be shortened depending on the outlook at the time.

The north/northeast part of the map in particular is open tussock and low scrub up to 780m and exposed to winds from any direction. People going there should carry waterproof parkas, windproof trousers, and a thick thermal top and hat in addition to their normal wool or polypropylene layers..

If you are in any doubt about the suitability of your equipment, *please* ask an organiser.

You should expect to get wet feet, although you will be able to cover large distances without having to cross streams.

Other Gear

Please bring a cup/mug for refreshments at the start-finish area. Bring toilet paper.
There will be NO rubbish facilities so bring your own rubbish bag.

Emergency

Blow your whistle (six blasts at one second intervals, repeated every few minutes) to assist any other team to find you. If you have a cell phone, call **027 351 0146 or 021 295 4880** but see below. Any team hearing the emergency call must respond and render assistance to the team that is in distress.

Cellphone reception is marginal or non-existent in most of the valleys, but is reasonable when on the ridges and higher land. As far as possible, the organizers will have a person in a known reception area for emergency calls on the hour for a period of five minutes. If you cannot make contact with the organizers, and it is a genuine emergency, call the Mosgiel Police directly – the contact number is printed on the map. State clearly that you are a rogaine competitor.

Scoring during the Event

The checkpoint value is the "tens" value of its number, so for example 37 is worth 30 points, 53 is worth 50 points. Each checkpoint is marked on the map as a 7mm diameter circle, with the checkpoint number beside it. Once at the checkpoint, marked with a short length of fluoro-pink tape, you must locate the

plastic tag with its code from the checkpoint description. Note the code on your checkpoint description sheet. There are no cryptic clue checkpoints!

Remember that in Rogaining there is a distinction between "the" and "a". For example, "The" watercourse means you can see it marked as a watercourse on the map, whereas "a" watercourse means that one exists, but it isn't marked on the map.

There is a late penalty of 10 points per minute or part thereof after the official finish times. Disqualification will occur 30 minutes after the finish times, which means no score at all.

All team members must visit each checkpoint claimed, to within 20 metres and in sight of it. Do not stop at a checkpoint for any longer than you need to complete the requirements. If you want to stop for a rest or a discussion, move to at least 100 metres away from the checkpoint.

Finish Procedure

At the finish hand your clue/score sheet to the administration staff. **Your entire team must be present at the finish together for a finish time to be recorded.** The penalty for finishing late is 10 points per minute (see above).

Protests

Reports of breaches of the rules, or protests against the event organisers, will be considered and determined by a three person jury. Such protests must be lodged in writing within 15 minutes of the end of the event. The jury panel shall be selected from members of the NZRA committee and NZRA regional contacts, members of the NZOF Rogaining committee, and recognized rogainers. It will exclude the course planner and vetter, who may however be consulted by the jury. The fee for lodging a protest is $20, which will be refunded if judgement is in your favour.

Rules of Competition

The Silver Peaks Rogaine will be run under the standard competition rules developed by the Australian Rogaining Association and which are available in full at http://www.rogaine.org.nz/main_files/Ozrules.htm A copy of the rules will be on the Notice Board at the event.

The following is an outline of some of the important rules:

- The only navigational aids that may be carried on the course are magnetic compasses, watches and copies of the competition map. **The possession of other navigational aids, including pedometers, altimeters (including those within sports watches) and GPS receivers on the course is prohibited.** The possession of non-competition maps is prohibited at the event venue.
- **Members of a team shall remain within unaided verbal contact of one another at all times whilst on the course. A team shall demonstrate compliance with this requirement to any event official or other team on request.**
- **All team members shall simultaneously approach to within 20 metres, and within sight, of each checkpoint for which points are claimed.**
- No fires are to be lit anywhere on the course, this includes the headquarters area.
- Competitors shall not discard litter or smoke on the course. If you must eat oranges please carry the peel home or bury it!
- Cell phones are for emergency use only.

After-the-finish refreshments

Light refreshments (biscuits, fruit and hot drinks) will be available, followed by a gathering at the Taieri Harrier Club rooms in Mosgiel. Help from early finishers will be appreciated.

Sunday 24th September Dunedin Orienteering Club event.
Cuttance Forest Block near Henly, about 35 km south of Dunedin.

All Rogaine participants are entitled to a $4.00 discount on the entry fee. Vouchers are available from the organizers.

TEAM NUMBER: _____

The Silver Peaks Rogaine September 23rd 2006

Indemnity and Emergency Contact

Teams will not be registered until the following forms have been completed and presented at the administration desk.

Indemnity

We, the undersigned, hereby acknowledge that the New Zealand Rogaining Association, Dunedin Rogaines, the Event Organisers, and the owners of the land used for this event, accept no liability for any loss, damage or injury to ourselves resulting from our participation in this event. We enter this event at our own risk and acknowledge that there may be risks associated with the sport of Rogaining.

Name	Signature	Date	Date of birth

Emergency Contact

Your Name and Car Registration Number	Emergency Contact (not a competitor) Name, Address, Phone No.	Allergies or Medical Condition

NOTE:

1. A parent or guardian must sign the indemnity form on behalf of a competitor under the age of 18
2. Supply the name, address and telephone number of a person to contact in the event of an emergency. This person must not be a competitor in the event.
3. Supply details of any medical conditions or allergies that might be of assistance to First Aid staff in the event of an accident or emergency.